



BUILDING A COLLECTION It wasn't until 1983 that Harsh Goenka purchased his first artwork—a painting from M. F. Husain's 'Mother Teresa' series

of collecting art has been the search for meaning. This search led me to collect a unique series of self-portraits by various artists. These works are windows into the minds of their creators—enigmatic, reclusive figures who communicate through their art. I've always been fascinated by the psychology of an artist and the ways in which they view themselves and others.

While I have many favourites, Akbar Padamsee's work holds a special place in my heart. His painting has adorned my office for years. I also have a deep admiration for Dalí, whose surrealistic works continue to mesmerise me. While I don't own any of his paintings (that remains a

dream), I am proud to own two of his sculptures.

PUBLIC ART, GIVING BACK

Art, for me, is not just a private pleasure. I believe in sharing art with the public, making it accessible. One of my proudest achievements has been commissioning public sculptures in Mumbai. These works, designed by renowned artists, now stand as cultural landmarks across the city. Public art has the power to elevate our collective experience of a city, offering moments of reflection in the midst of our busy lives.

THE FUTURE OF INDIAN ART

The Indian art scene is incredibly

vibrant today. Since the days of the Progressive Artists' Group, Indian contemporary art has gained international acclaim. Today, our artists are celebrated globally, and the digital medium is pushing boundaries. Online auctions have made it easier for collectors to acquire pieces, and AI is becoming a hot topic. As technology evolves, the possibilities are limitless.

INVESTING IN ART

More and more people in India are turning to art as an investment. While art can indeed appreciate in value, I don't view it solely as a financial asset. For me, art is about personal fulfilment. When you begin to see art as a commodity, the experience loses some of its magic. That being said, the beauty of art as an investment is that, unlike stocks or gold, you can enjoy it every day.

ADVICE TO ASPIRING COLLECTORS

To those just beginning their journey as collectors, my advice is simple: immerse yourself in the art world. The more you see, the more you will understand what speaks to you. Keep an open mind, visit galleries, ask questions, and most importantly, buy what moves you. Don't compromise on quality, and always purchase from reputable dealers. Art is not just about ownership—it's about the journey of discovery.

In a world filled with distractions, art offers a bridge that connects us across cultures and experiences. Whether you're a serious collector or an admirer, art is a path worth exploring. **BT**

The author is Chairman, RPG Enterprises. Views are personal